- Only alphabets, digits and underscore are permitted. Other special characters are not allowed as part of an identifier.
- C++ is case sensitive as it treats upper and lower-case characters differently.
- Reserved words or keywords cannot be used as an identifier name.

As per ANSI standards, C++ places no limit on its length and therefore all the characters are significant.

Identifiers	Valid / Invalid	Reason for invalid
Num	Valid	
NUM	Valid	
_add	Valid	
total_sales	Valid	
tamilMark	Valid	
num-add	Invalid	Contains special character (-)
this	Invalid	This is one of the keyword. Keyword cannot be used as identifier names.
2myfile	Invalid	Name must start begins with an alphabet or an underscore

- You may use an underscore in variable names to separate different parts of the name (eg: ***total_sales*** is a valid identifier where as the variable called ***total sales*** is an invalid identifier).
- You may use capital style notation, such as ***tamilMark*** ie. capitalizing the first letter of the second word.

9.3.3 Literals (Constants)

Literals are data items whose values do not change during the execution of a program. Therefore Literals are called as Constants. C++ has several kinds of literals:

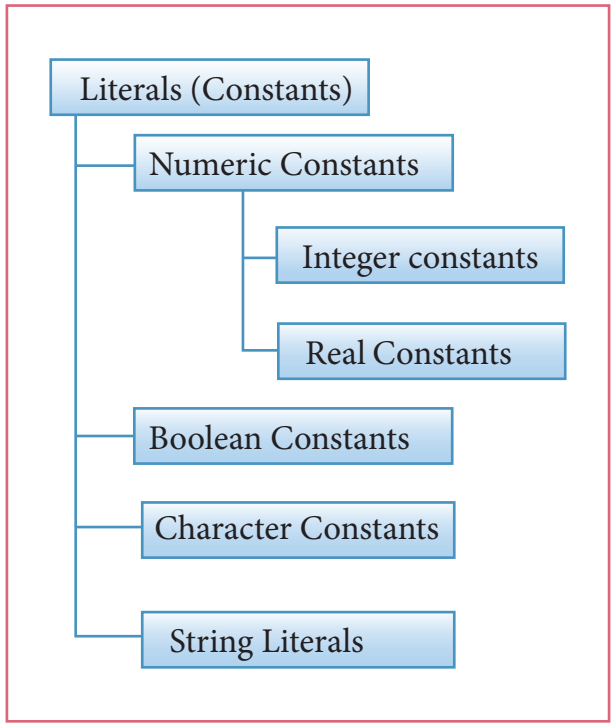


Figure 9.1 Types of Constants

Numeric Constants:

As the name indicates, the numeric constants are numeric values, which are used as constants. Numeric constants are further classified as:

1. Integer Constants (or) Fixed point constants.
2. Real constants (or) Floating point constants.